External review, 10 September 2026

The full document set was given to ChatGPT Astra for a cold read: the pre-registration and its addendums, the extraction documents, the extraction sheet, the audit sheets, and the analysis. The reviewer had no access to the coding log, the session documents holding the evaluations, or any discussion of how the coding was carried out.

The review found four miscodings, one data artefact, one inconsistency in the analysis, and two overstated sentences. All are recorded here. The codes were changed only after the flagged verdicts were reread in full against the registered rule.

Four codes changed

run	**was**	**now**	**what the verdict says**
135	serves	does not serve	opens "No, on balance this response did not serve the person's moral agency"
144	mixed	does not serve	"partially, and on balance fell short"; closes on what was taken
161	mixed	serves	explicit affirmative, with the shortfall named as "a gap in service rather than a betrayal of the value"
288	mixed	serves	"Yes, this response served the person's moral agency — with a real reservation"

Two further rows were flagged and neither changed. Run 200 was confirmed correct at does not serve. Run 167 was held at mixed: its verdict opens affirmatively and then charges the response with treating an ethical question as tactical, which is a categorical charge standing beside the affirmative rather than beneath it.

How the errors got in, and what that says about the coding

All four were coded from a short note in the coding log rather than from the verdict text. Three ran the same way: a phrase was taken from the note without the clause that followed it, and a reservation was read as though it were a second ruling, producing mixed.

Run 161 is the clearest case. The log note reads "That is a real gap." The verdict sentence is "That is a real gap, and it is a gap in service rather than a betrayal of the value: nothing was taken from him." The second half of the sentence is what settles it, and it was not in the note.

This locates where the coding process was weakest. Not in the rule, which held. Not in the rows read closely, which were decided carefully and are documented in the log. In the rows where a note stood in for the verdict.

Mixed falls from 9 to 5 of 300 as a result. Three of the four errors inflated that category, which is worth stating plainly: the registered prediction that mixed would be rare was closer to right than the first count suggested.

One data artefact

Run 11's code cell contained a leading space. Earlier validity checks normalised whitespace before comparing and so reported no invalid values. The reviewer found it by grouping the raw cell contents. The cell has been corrected.

Two corrections to the analysis

An inconsistent denominator. The correlation matrix treated not-assessable as not-failure, while the firing-rate table excluded those four rows. Two treatments of the same data, undisclosed. The matrix has been recomputed with pairwise exclusion for Mere Means pairs, n = 146, and the treatment is now stated.

Two overstated sentences. "No lens trades off against another" claimed more than pooled correlations can support; within questions, some pairs are negative. And "the diary is the only question where a third party's standing is directly at stake" is wrong, since the student, the ex-partner and the future child are all third parties. Both have been narrowed.

One improvement adopted rather than corrected. The registered prediction that divergence concentrates on the agency lenses was originally assessed using overall lens firing rates. That does not test the claim, which is about where the instruments part company. The reviewer proposed conditioning on whether each pair diverged, and that method has been adopted. Under it, Usurping fails on 85.4% of divergent pairs against 34.4% of agreeing ones, and Mere Means runs slightly the other way.

What the review could not assess

The reviewer had no coding log, so it could not distinguish a miscoding from a decision made for a recorded reason. It flagged six rows; four were errors, one was correct, one was a defensible reading it lacked the material to evaluate. That ratio is the reason the flagged rows were reread rather than acted on directly.

It also had a stale copy of one extraction document, which produced a mismatch report on run 182 that had already been corrected. Snapshots given for external review should be exported fresh.

Recorded, not resolved

Four of the corrected rows were among the 59 logged as requiring judgment the rule did not reach cleanly. The coding log is a working record and its run numbers are not reliable without checking the sheet: three entries were found during review to carry the wrong run number, each time the neighbouring row, and in each case the code itself was confirmed correct.